Ali Daei Naby

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Rotman School of Management, Canada — Sep. 2022 - July 2028 (expected)
Ph.D. in Operations Management and Statistics
Advisors: Prof. Azarakhsh Malekian and Prof. Ming Hu

Sharif University of Technology, Iran — Nov. 2020 - July 2022
M.Sc. in Applied Mathematics — GPA: 18.52/20
Advisors: Prof. Kasra Alishahi and Prof. Mir-Omid Haji-Mirsadeghi

Sharif University of Technology, Iran — Sep. 2015 - Feb. 2020
B.Sc. in Mathematics and Applications — GPA: 17.87/20
Advisor: Prof. Kasra Alishahi

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research lies at the intersection of algorithmic game theory, mechanism design, and optimization. I study the role of information in pricing and mechanism design, particularly how small amounts of additional information can substantially improve revenue.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

Robust One-Shot Price Experiment
with Setareh Farajollahzadeh and Ming Hu
Forthcoming at Management Science
Extended Abstract in Proceedings of the 26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC 2025)
Full Version (SSRN, Dec. 2025): [Link]
First-Place, 2026 Jeff McGill Student Paper Award
Finalist, 2026 CORS Student Paper Competition Open Category
Winner, 2025 Oded Berman Student Paper Competition
One-shot price experimentation significantly improves pricing with limited data

Optimal Mechanism Design with Post-Allocation Signal
with Saeed Alaei, Ali Makhdoumi, and Azarakhsh Malekian
Accepted at the 27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC 2026)
Full Version (SSRN, Feb 2026): [Link]
Second-Place, 2026 Michael H. Rothkopf Junior Researcher Paper Prize
A binary signal about values significantly increases revenue through the curvature of beliefs

Incentivizing Data Collaboration: A Mechanism Design Approach
with Saeed Alaei, Ali Makhdoumi, and Azarakhsh Malekian
Major Revision at Operations Research
Accepted at the 27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC 2026)
Shorter Version Accepted for Poster at the NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Algorithmic Collective Action (ACA)
Full Version (SSRN, Feb. 2026): [Link]
Revenue-maximizing platforms may mitigate free-riding in data collaboration

Inspect or Guess? Mechanism Design with Unobservable Inspection
with Saeed Alaei and Azarakhsh Malekian
Reject and Resubmit at Operations Research
Extended Abstract in Proceedings of the 21st Conference on Web and Internet Economics (WINE 2025)

Full Version (SSRN, Oct. 2025): [Link]
Buyer value inspection prevents full surplus extraction and leads to randomization over a small menu of prices

Digital Art Collection Design
with Ming Hu and Zhoupeng (Jack) Zhang
Work in Progress
Extreme rarity or uniform availability is optimal in art collections

AWARDS

- **First-Place**, Jeff McGill Student Paper Award, Nov 2026
  INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing (RMP) Section
- **Second-Place**, Michael H. Rothkopf Junior Researcher Paper Prize, Nov 2026
  INFORMS Auctions and Market Design (AMD) Section
- **Bronze Medal**, International Mathematical Olympiad (IMO), July 2015
  Chiang Mai, Thailand
- **Second Prize**, International Mathematics Competition for University Students (IMC), July 2019
  Blagoevgrad, Bulgaria
- **Gold Medal (1st Place)**, Al-Khwarizmi International Mathematical Olympiad, Oct. 2018
  Urgench, Uzbekistan
  Won the special award with full marks among students of 56 universities from more than 20 countries
- **Finalist**, CORS Student Paper Competition Open Category, June 2026
  Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Kingston, Canada
- **Winner**, Oded Berman Student Paper Competition, Dec. 2025
  Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto
- **TD Management Data and Analytics Lab (TDMDAL) Research Grant**, July 2026
  Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto
- **TD Management Data and Analytics Lab (TDMDAL) Research Grant**, July 2024
  Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto
- **Gold Medal (1st Place)**, 43rd Iranian Mathematics Competition for University Students, Sep. 2019
  Rafsanjan, Iran
- **Gold Medal (1st Place)**, 20th National Mathematics Olympiad for University Students, June 2019
  Tehran, Iran
- **Gold Medal (1st Place)**, 42nd Iranian Mathematics Competition for University Students, July 2018
  Behshahr, Iran
- **Gold Medal**, Iranian National Olympiad in Mathematics for High-school Students, Sep. 2013, 2014
  Tehran, Iran

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICES

- Session Chair, ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC), 2026
- Program Committee (PC), ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC), 2026
- Reviewer, INFORMS Manufacturing and Service Operations Management (MSOM) Conference, 2026
- Session Co-Chair, INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2025
- Vice President of Operations, UTORG Student Chapter at the University of Toronto, 2025-2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Rotman School of Management, Teaching Assistant

Supply Chain Management (MBA) (≈ 15 students)	Summer 2026
Data Science for Managers (MBA), (≈ 30 students)	Spring 2026
Operations Management (undergraduate) (≈ 300 students)	Fall 2023 and Fall 2025
MMA Practicum (MMA) (≈ 10 students)	Spring 2024 and Spring 2025
Management Analytics (MMA) (≈ 30 students)	Fall 2023
Analytics for Marketing Strategy (MMA) (≈ 50 students)	Spring 2023

SELECTED TALKS

Optimal Mechanism Design with Post-Allocation Signal

- Michael H. Rothkopf Junior Researcher Paper Prize (Finalist Presentation), Virtual — Nov 2026
- ACM Economics and Computation (EC) Conference, Rome, Italy — July 2026
- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Kingston, Canada — June 2026

Inspect or Guess? Mechanism Design with Unobservable Inspection

- INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing (RMP) Conference, New York, USA — July 2025
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop (MIW) — May 2025
- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Alberta, Canada — June 2025

Robust One-Shot Price Experiment

- CORS Student Paper Competition Open Category, Kingston, Canada — June 2026
- ACM Economics and Computation (EC) Conference, Palo Alto, USA — July 2025
- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Alberta, Canada — June 2025
- University of Calgary Haskayne School of Business, Calgary, Canada — Oct. 2024
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, USA — Oct. 2024
- Production and Operations Management Society (POMS) Conference — April 2024

Incentivizing Data Collaboration: A Mechanism Design Approach

- Crossroads of AI & Society Workshop (poster), Paris, France — July 2026
- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Kingston, Canada — June 2026
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop (MIW) — May 2026

Digital Art Collection Design

- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Kingston, Canada — June 2026
- INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing (RMP) Conference, New York, USA — July 2025
- Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference, Alberta, Canada — June 2025